STRATEGIC IMPERATIVES

Frontline Leader Conversation Guide

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How to Use This Guide

A practical guide for encouraging reflection, discussion and dialogue about what the Strategic Imperatives mean for daily work, patient and service experiences, handoffs, teamwork and practical barriers.

PURPOSE	Help frontline leaders move from communicating the Strategic Imperatives to facilitating a focused conversation that creates shared meaning, local relevance and visible action.

What this guide helps leaders do

1. Prepare for the Conversation

Use the cascade deck as the enterprise anchor. This guide provides prompts and follow-through to make the message relevant to the team.

Before the session

- Know the audience. Consider what the team already knows and which parts of the message connect most directly to daily work.
- Select local examples. Prepare two or three examples from patient care, service, teamwork, safety or a process the team can influence.
- Choose the discussion focus. Discuss all four imperatives briefly or explore one or two in more depth.
- Anticipate questions. Note barriers the team may raise and what needs to be brought to another leader or forum.
- Prepare a visible commitment. Decide what the team should see or hear from you after the conversation.
- Plan follow-through. Choose where and when you will revisit commitments and unanswered questions.

Preparation worksheet

Preparation item	Leader notes
Audience	Who will participate, and what do they most need to understand?
Local example 1	Which current priority, patient experience or decision illustrates an imperative?
Local example 2	Which behavior or outcome should the team connect to?
Discussion focus	Which imperative and reflection question will generate the most useful dialogue?

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Preparation item	Leader notes
My visible commitment	What will the team see or hear from me?
Follow-up point	When and where will progress or open questions be revisited?

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2. Open and Frame the Conversation

SUGGESTED OPENING	"Today we will connect our mission and Strategic Imperatives to the work we do with patients, families and one another. I want to hear where you already see the imperatives in action and what would help us bring them to life more consistently."

Establish the "why"

- Our mission remains constant. The Strategic Imperatives focus how Orlando Health delivers the mission.
- The imperatives create shared focus across the enterprise.
- They guide priorities, decisions and trade-offs.
- They connect leadership behavior and daily work to outcomes.
- They are an enterprise leadership and decision framework that works as one connected story.

Set expectations for dialogue

- This is a conversation, not a test. There is no expectation that everyone will use the same words.
- Focus on understanding, practical connection and what should be visible in the work.
- Different perspectives are useful. Listen for common themes and issues that need follow-up.
- Close with one action or commitment, not a long list of ideas.

Opening questions

- "What stands out to you as you hear the four Strategic Imperatives?"
- "Which imperative do you see most clearly in our daily work?"
- "Where could we make the connection to patients, families or teammates stronger?"

FACILITATION CUE	Pause for a few seconds after asking a question. Invite two or three responses, then summarize the common thread before continuing.

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3. Use a Four-Move Conversation

Use the sequence below to keep discussion focused. Ask one question at a time and move from meaning to application.

1. REFLECT | Allow individuals to form a point of view before discussion.

Leader language: “Take a moment to consider where this imperative is already visible in our work and where the connection may be less clear.”

- Allow a brief pause.
- Invite people to write down one thought if helpful.
- Do not fill the silence too quickly.

2. DISCUSS | Surface perspectives, questions and differences in experience.

Leader language: “What does this imperative mean for our team and the work we do?”

- Invite two or three responses.
- Ask for an example when an answer is broad.
- Acknowledge different perspectives without debating each point.

3. CONNECT | Translate meaning into priorities, decisions, behaviors and outcomes.

Leader language: “What should this change or reinforce in the way we prioritize, decide and work?”

- Use a current local example.
- Ask what others would see or experience.
- Identify barriers or opportunities that deserve follow-up.

4. COMMIT | Convert dialogue into a visible next action.

Leader language: “Based on this discussion, what is one thing we should do differently or more consistently?”

- Name the action or behavior.
- Clarify ownership.
- State where the commitment will be revisited.

LISTEN AND SYNTHESIZE	Use language such as: “What I am hearing is…,” “The connection to our work is…,” and “The area we need to strengthen is….”

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4. Discussion Prompts by Strategic Imperative

Demand Excellence in All We Do

Enterprise meaning: Demonstrate the highest level of performance in quality, patient care and economics.

Choose one primary question and one probe:

- “Where can we raise or more consistently reinforce the standard in our daily work?”
- “Where are expectations clear, and where might they be inconsistent?”
- “What would patients, families or teammates notice if we improved?”
- “What tools, training or support would help us meet the standard?”

Possible synthesis: “Excellence must be visible in the outcomes we deliver and in how we support people to deliver them.”

Partner with Physicians

Enterprise meaning: Create meaningful partnerships grounded in trust and credibility.

Choose one primary question and one probe:

- “Where could earlier physician engagement strengthen a decision, handoff or outcome?”
- “What would meaningful partnership look like at the beginning of the work?”
- “Where could clearer communication improve trust or follow-through?”
- “What perspective should be included before we move forward?”

Possible synthesis: “We can strengthen partnership by listening early, communicating clearly and following through.”

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4. Discussion Prompts by Strategic Imperative

Be the Best Place to Work

Enterprise meaning: Promote a culture that values individuals, and teamwork that results in organizational pride.

Choose one primary question and one probe:

- “What helps people on this team feel respected and able to do their best?”
- “What should patients, families or teammates notice about how we work together?”
- “Where would clearer communication or role expectations help?”
- “How can we share feedback and recognize good teamwork?”

Possible synthesis: “A strong team experience grows through respect, clear communication, teamwork and recognition.”

Drive Growth and Innovation

Enterprise meaning: Execute on opportunities to create sustainable competitive advantage.

Choose one primary question and one probe:

- “What small improvement could make care or service better?”
- “What gets in the way of trying a better way to work?”
- “Where could an idea from the team help patients or coworkers?”
- “What change should we raise for consideration by leaders?”

Possible synthesis: “Frontline ideas can improve care and work. We should recognize them, test them through the right channels and close the loop.”

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5. Connect the Imperatives to Day-to-Day Work

Use four practical lenses to move from broad agreement to specific implications. Use all four lenses or select the two most relevant to the conversation.

Lens	Discussion question	Useful follow-up
PRIORITIES	What should receive focus, time or resources?	What may need less attention so this can be prioritized?
DECISIONS	How should the imperatives guide choices or trade-offs?	Which imperative provides the clearest lens for this decision?
BEHAVIORS	What should leaders and teams do consistently?	What would people see or hear if this behavior were strong?
OUTCOMES	How will patients, physicians, team members or communities experience the difference?	What evidence would tell us the imperative is becoming real?

Use local examples without changing the enterprise message

- Start with: “For our team, this means...”
- Name a current priority, decision, behavior or outcome the team recognizes.
- Make the connection to a specific imperative explicit.
- Keep the example brief so there is time for dialogue rather than a project update.

EXAMPLE LANGUAGE	“For our team, demanding excellence means following the agreed process, speaking up when something may affect safety or experience, and asking for help when a barrier prevents us from meeting the standard.”

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6. Manage Common Conversation Moments

If the room is quiet

- Offer a concrete example, then ask: “Where else do you see this in our work?”
- Allow 30 seconds for individual reflection before inviting responses.
- Ask for a choice: “Which lens matters most right now: priorities, decisions, behaviors or outcomes?”
- Invite one person to build on the example rather than asking broadly for “any thoughts.”

If discussion becomes too broad

- Refocus: “Let’s bring this back to what we can do in our daily work and what needs leader follow-up.”
- Ask: “Which patient, service or teamwork outcome does this connect to?”
- Capture topics that need a separate discussion or escalation.

If concern or disagreement surfaces

- Acknowledge the perspective without becoming defensive.
- Clarify what is known and what requires follow-up.
- Ask what the concern means for successful implementation or alignment.
- Avoid trying to resolve complex operational issues during the cascade conversation.

If a question cannot be answered

SUGGESTED RESPONSE	“That is an important question. I do not want to speculate. I will capture it, confirm the appropriate information and bring the answer back through [specific forum or communication].”

Avoid these patterns

- Reading every slide word for word.
- Asking broad questions such as “Any thoughts?”
- Requiring every person to speak.
- Debating each comment or solving every issue in the moment.
- Creating a long list of commitments without clear ownership.
- Changing the enterprise meaning of an imperative to fit a local example.

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7. Close with Commitment and Follow-Through

Synthesize what you heard

- "What I am hearing is…"
- "The strongest connection to our work is…"
- "The opportunity for us is…"
- "The behavior that needs to be more visible is…"

Confirm one visible commitment

TEAM COMMITMENT STATEMENT	"For our team, this imperative means we will _____ so that _____."

- Make the action observable and within the team's influence.
- Name who owns the next step.
- Clarify what progress or success will look like.
- State when and where the team will revisit the commitment.

Suggested close

"The Strategic Imperatives give us a shared focus for the care and service we provide. Based on today's conversation, you will see us _____. We will revisit this commitment in _____."

Final leader check

☐ Can the team explain why the Strategic Imperatives matter?
☐ Can people identify where the imperatives connect to day-to-day work?
☐ Did the conversation surface a useful example, barrier or opportunity?
☐ Is there one clear action or behavior that will be visible next?
☐ Is follow-up ownership clear?

LEADER REMINDER	"The communication is credible when team members see the connection in the choices, actions and follow-through they experience each day."

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